Kentucky Department of
EDUCATION

Kentucky Summative Assessment (KSA)
Performance Level Descriptors (PLDs)
Grade 4

Reading – Grade 4

Distinguished

A student performing at the Distinguished performance level for grade 4 Reading consistently reads closely, using details and examples from the text as well as explicit and implicit evidence, to support an explanation of what the text says and to analyze how the theme or central ideas are reflected in the text. The student routinely demonstrates the ability to describe and analyze how and why characters/individuals, events and ideas are connected over the course of the text. The student skillfully analyzes structure in the overall text or parts of the text. The student consistently compares and contrasts point of view and firsthand/secondhand account of events or topics in the text. The student is adept at determining the meaning of words, phrases and figurative language in the text, including how they shape meaning of the text. The student adeptly compares and contrasts themes, topics and events in a variety of texts from different cultures.

Proficient

A student performing at the Proficient performance level for grade 4 Reading usually reads closely, using details and examples from the text as well as explicit and implicit evidence, to support an explanation of what the text says and to analyze how the theme or central ideas are reflected in the text. The student often demonstrates the ability to describe and analyze how and why characters/individuals, events and ideas are connected over the course of the text. The student usually analyzes structure in the overall text or parts of the text. The student often compares and contrasts point of view and firsthand/secondhand account of events or topics in the text the student often determines the meaning of words, phrases and figurative language in the text, including how they shape meaning of the text. The student accurately compares themes, topics and events in a variety of texts from different cultures.

Apprentice

A student performing at the Apprentice performance level for grade 4 Reading sometimes reads closely, using details and examples from the text as well as explicit and implicit evidence, to support an explanation of what the text says and to analyze how the theme or central ideas are reflected in the text. The student demonstrates adequate ability to describe and analyze how and why characters/individuals, events and ideas are connected over the course of the text. The student attempts to analyze structure in the overall text or parts of the text. The student adequately compares and contrasts point of view and firsthand/secondhand account of events or topics in the text. The student sometimes determines the meaning of words, phrases and figurative language in the text, including how they shape meaning of the text. The student

attempts to compare themes, topics and events in a variety of texts from different cultures.

Novice
A student performing at the Novice performance level for grade 4 Reading rarely reads closely, using details and examples from the text as well as explicit and implicit evidence, to support an explanation of what the text says and to analyze how the theme or central ideas are reflected in the text. The student demonstrates minimal ability to describe and analyze how and why characters/individuals, events and ideas are connected over the course of the. The student rarely analyzes structure in the overall text or parts of the text. The student minimally compares and contrasts point of view and firsthand/secondhand account of events or topics in the text. The student demonstrates minimal ability to determine the meaning of words, phrases and figurative language in the text, including how they shape meaning of the text. The student demonstrates little ability to compare themes, topics and events in a variety of texts from different cultures.

Mathematics – Grade 4

Distinguished
A student performing at the Distinguished performance level for grade 4 Mathematics consistently makes sense of quantities and their relationships in problem situations. The student routinely demonstrates the ability to flexibly choose among methods and strategies to solve contextual and mathematical problems, understand and explain their approaches and produce accurate answers efficiently. The student effectively interprets mathematical relationships. The student is adept at identifying key features and applying correspondences between multiple representations, such as place value, multiplication and division, estimation, fractions, and shapes.

Proficient
A student performing at the Proficient performance level for grade 4 Mathematics often makes sense of quantities and their relationships in problem situations. The student usually demonstrates the ability to flexibly choose among methods and strategies to solve contextual and mathematical problems, understand and explain their approaches and produce accurate answers efficiently. The student generally interprets mathematical relationships. The student is adept at identifying key features and applying correspondences between multiple representations, such as place value, multiplication and division, estimation, fractions, and shapes.

Apprentice
A student performing at the Apprentice performance level for grade 4 Mathematics attempts to make sense of quantities and their relationships in problem situations. The student sometimes demonstrates the ability to flexibly choose among methods and strategies to solve contextual and mathematical problems, understand and explain their approaches and produce accurate answers efficiently. The student interprets a few mathematical relationships. The student attempts to identify key features and apply correspondences between multiple

representations, such as place value, estimation, multiplication and division, fractions, and shapes, but the results indicate a lack of clarity or a lack of consistency.

Novice
A student performing at the Novice performance level for grade 4 Mathematics displays little understanding of how to make sense of quantities and their relationships in problem situations. The student rarely demonstrates the ability to flexibly choose among methods and strategies to solve contextual and mathematical problems, understand and explain their approaches and produce accurate answers efficiently. The student interprets mathematical relationships ineffectively or inaccurately. The student minimally or inappropriately attempts to identify key features and apply correspondences between multiple representations, such as place value, multiplication and division, estimation, fractions, and shapes.

Science – Grade 4

Distinguished
A student performing at the Distinguished level for grade 4 science consistently explains phenomena and designs solutions with depth, precision, and sophistication by integrating and applying science and engineering practices through the lens of crosscutting concepts. The student demonstrates clear, comprehensive understanding across the full range of disciplinary core ideas for grades K–4.

The distinguished student consistently asks insightful questions, defines and investigates problems, and develops and refines models of structures and processes—such as waves, energy transfer, weathering and erosion, Earth features, or plant and animal systems—to predict and explain outcomes. The student consistently skillfully analyzes and interprets data, applying mathematical reasoning where appropriate, and consistently constructs well-reasoned explanations and designs solutions that are supported by multiple sources of evidence. The student effectively engages in arguments from evidence and communicates scientific ideas with precision, using crosscutting concepts such as patterns, cause and effect, energy and matter, systems and system models, and structure and function to organize and connect ideas in sophisticated ways.

Proficient
A student performing at the Proficient level for grade 4 science can usually explain phenomena and design solutions by integrating and applying science and engineering practices, often through the lens of crosscutting concepts. The student applies these practices to demonstrate understanding clearly and effectively across most of the full range of core disciplinary science ideas for kindergarten through grade 4.

The proficient student often asks questions and plans investigations that produce data to explain patterns, cause-and-effect relationships, and system interactions. The student usually develops and uses models of structures and processes—such as waves, energy transfer, weathering and erosion, or plant and animal systems—and usually accurately analyzes and interprets data to identify

patterns, describe relationships, and connect evidence to scientific principles. The student often constructs explanations, designs solutions, and engages in argument from evidence, evaluating and comparing data to support claims and communicate scientific ideas.

Apprentice

A student performing at the Apprentice level for grade 4 science demonstrates a partial understanding of science and engineering practices and applies them with limited accuracy or consistency. The student sometimes asks questions, plans investigations, or develops and uses models, but does so at a basic level. Data analysis and interpretation may be incomplete, and explanations or solutions are often general or only partially supported by evidence.

A student at this level shows an emerging ability to apply practices to demonstrate partial understanding of some disciplinary core ideas for grades K–4, such as waves, energy transfer, weathering and erosion, Earth features, or plant and animal structures. Crosscutting concepts—such as patterns, cause and effect, and systems and system models—are beginning to be used but in a basic, limited, or occasionally inaccurate way.

Novice

A student performing at the Novice level for grade 4 science demonstrates minimal understanding of science and engineering practices and has difficulty applying them appropriately. The student rarely asks questions, plans investigations, or develops and uses models in meaningful ways, and rarely analyzes or interprets data. Explanations and solutions are often incomplete, inaccurate, or lack evidence, and attempts at argument from evidence or communication of ideas are limited.

A student at this level does not or rarely applies practices to demonstrate understanding of disciplinary core ideas for grades K–4. Crosscutting concepts such as patterns, cause and effect, or systems are seldom used, and when attempted, are often applied inaccurately. Misconceptions about foundational science content are common.